

The molecular formula of gypsum is $CaSO_4 \cdot 2H_2O$.

Uses

- Used as fertilizers.
- Used in the process of making cement.
- In the process of making Plaster of Paris.

3.5 Epsom



Epsom salt is **magnesium sulphate hydrate.** The molecular formula of Epsom is $MgSO_4 . 7H_2O$. It offers a wide range of uses.

Uses

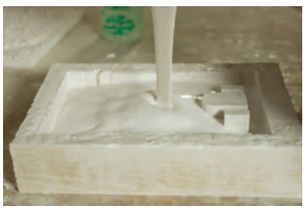
- Eases stress and relaxes the body
- Helps muscles and nerves function properly
- Medicine for skin problems
- Improving plant growth in agriculture

3.6 Plaster of Paris

Plaster of Paris consists of fine white powder **(calcium sulphate hemihydrate)** The molecular formula of Plaster of Paris is $CaSO_4 . 1/2H_2O$. Known since ancient times, plaster of paris is so called because of its preparation from the abundant gypsum found near Paris, capital of France. Plaster of paris is prepared by heating gypsum, where it gets partially dehydrated.

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Uses

- In making black board chalks.
- In surgery for setting fractured bones.
- For making casts for statues and toys etc.
- In construction industry.

3.7 Phenol

Have you ever observed the oily material which is used to clean your house? Do you know what it is? It is a chemical, named as Phenol.



Phenol is a **carbolic acid** of an organic compound. It is a necessary ingredient for preparing variety of phenol products. The molecular formula of phenol is C_6H_5 OH, it is a weak acid. It is a volatile, white crystalline powder.

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